🌻 Introduction to data collection with Qualia

Chapter contents.

> Qualia is our AI interviewer.

You can use Qualia to collect data for causal mapping: Task 1 — Introduction. You can use it for other kinds of data collection too.

In-depth interviews, automated.

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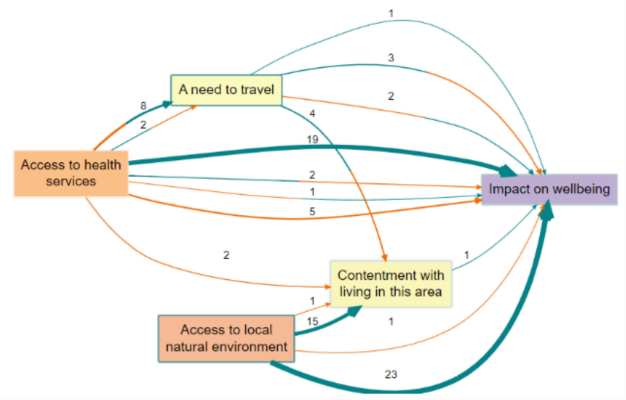
QualiaInterviews

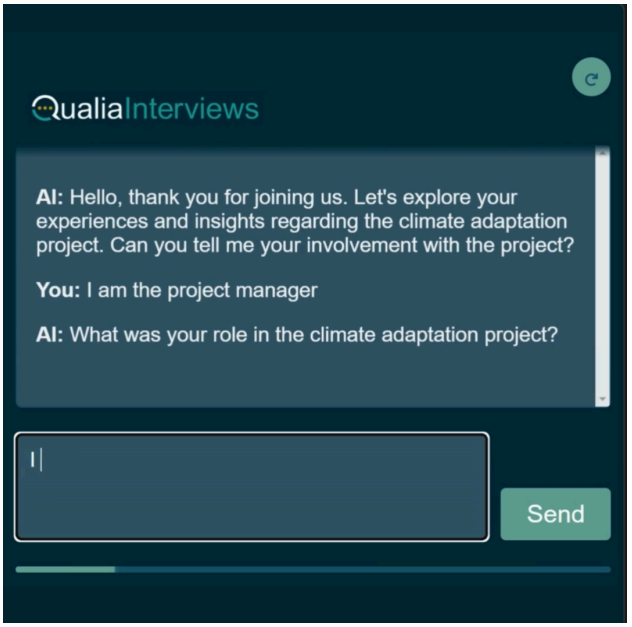
Go beyond questionnaires and “free text” answers. Find out what people are really thinking, in their own words:

- What worked and why?
- What didn’t work, and why?
- What new issues are emerging?



How does it work?

1. Design and test your Qualia interview online.
2. Send your respondents a link to the interview.
3. Your respondents click on the link. Our friendly AI-interviewer guides them through the whole interview. They can type or speak their answers.
4. Get an automated report. Or download the transcripts for further analysis.



If you want to know what buttons to press for setting up, sharing and managing your interviews, look at the Qualia technical documentation, including How do you create a really great interview? How to manage languages?

This chapter (which is a constant work in progress) gives you the background, including research have we done on Qualia and some case studies.

PAGES IN THIS CHAPTER

The potential of AI interviewing and conversational research

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Our paper on an inductive workflow to gather and analyse evidence at scale.

Our method comprised the following steps (following Tasks 1-3 according to Powell, Copestake, et al. (2023, p. 108-112):

Case study – our 'seamless stories' workflow in practice

At Causal Map we're thrilled because our seamless AI-supported workflow is finally coming together. Recently we helped colleagues at a University in Chile to complete a qualitative, explorative evaluation of the impact of a programme, using our automated interviewer **Qualia** to conduct the interviews and **Causal Map** to make sense of them.

Case study – Qualia asks about USA problems, again

How can we capture and visualise people's mental models of a complex situation like the state of a nation? This week, as part of an EES webinar demonstrating our automated AI interviewer Qualia, we asked the participants to spend a few minutes being interviewed about problems facing the USA and the reasons for them, and the reasons for the reasons. Over 90 people did, with a mean of 13 messages per conversation. Details below.

How Qualia copes with different languages

There are two things to think about:

- 🎤 the transcription service (necessary only if we enable the option for people to speak instead of type)
- 👩‍🏫 the AI interviewer service which provides interviewer responses.

People are often more candid with machines than with other people. Why?

[@gambinoBuildingStrongerCASA2020]

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